



Motivation Comes Second

Everything you need to run this lesson is on this page.

Before you start. Nothing students write in this lesson is collected, read out or marked, and the deck tells them so twice. A few of them will be avoiding something because of what is happening at home, so stay somewhere in the room where they can speak to you at the end.

Print these four

Page	What it is	How many
Page 2	The lesson sheet	One per student
Page 3	Something to start cards	One set per class
Page 4	Sorting cards	One set per table
Page 5	Exit slips	One per student

The hour

Time	What happens	Slides
0 to 5	They write about a time they felt motivated, and what set it off. Silent, on the sheet.	3
5 to 13	Take the third question only. Collect every answer on the board, then ask what they have in common. All of them had already happened.	4 to 6
13 to 18	Teach the order: you start, something moves, and then you feel like it.	7 to 8
18 to 24	Shrink a task out loud until nobody could refuse it, then the class shrinks three.	9 to 10
24 to 27	They write down three things they are avoiding and score each one out of ten.	11
27 to 40	The experiment. They take the one they scored lowest, shrink it, work on it for five silent minutes, then score it again.	12 to 13
40 to 47	Why starting is the expensive bit, then three questions with no right answer.	14 to 15
47 to 60	Busy is not the same as full: the saying, then the sorting cards. Exit slip, and close.	16 to 20

Shrinking a task, when they get stuck

A task is still too big if it takes more than two minutes to make a start on it. It also has to be something they can do at their desk, so anything that lives at home gets shrunk to the preparing rather than the doing.

What they say	The five-minute version
Revise for the test	Open the booklet and read one page
Tidy my room	Write down the five things to move first
Get fit	Write when and where, once, on the sheet
Reply to that message	Write the reply. Do not send it yet





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The lesson sheet

Nobody collects this. Nobody reads it but you.

Part one: a time you actually wanted to do something

It does not have to be school. Anything at all.

What was it, and roughly when?

What were you doing in the hour before it?

What set it off?

Part two: three things you have been avoiding

One from school, one from home, one that is only for you. Fill the first two columns now and leave the rest blank.

Where	The thing I have been avoiding	Want to do it? /10	The smallest first move	After five minutes /10
School				
Home				
Just me				

When the slide says so: take the one you scored lowest, shrink it until you could do it sitting here, do it for five minutes, then score it again.





Something to start

For anyone who says they have nothing. Every one can be finished in five minutes, sitting down, with a pen.



START HERE

Write a list of everything you owe in the next seven days, with the day each one is due.



START HERE

Write down the three questions you would ask about the topic you understand least.



START HERE

Copy out the eight words, dates or formulas you always get wrong.



START HERE

Write the message you have been meaning to send. Do not send it yet.



START HERE

Write down what you would do tomorrow morning if the day went well. Be specific.



START HERE

Pick a piece of work you got back. Write the one thing you would change about it.



START HERE

Write down the name of somebody you should thank, and the sentence you would say.



START HERE

Make a list of everything in your bag that should not be in your bag.





Action, motion or rest

One set per table. Three piles: it moved something, it only felt like it, or it was rest you chose on purpose. Three of these are meant to cause an argument.

Did one past paper question	Colour-coded a revision timetable	Went to bed early on purpose
Wrote the first two sentences	Watched a video about how to revise	Walked home the long way on purpose
Booked the appointment	Reorganised your desk first	Watched a film you actually chose
Copied the vocab you keep missing	Read the same question fourteen times	Sat with friends and did not mention work
Said no to something to finish something else	Lost forty minutes without deciding to	Tidied your room before starting revision





The exit slip

One per student, cut up. Not collected, not read, not marked. They keep it.



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The thing I have been avoiding

My first move, small enough to do

When I am doing it

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